

VertiGO!!!



Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club, Wellington Section

NO. 729 JUNE 2010, PO BOX 1628 WELLINGTON



Kawakawa Bay
Photo courtesy of Vincent Zintzen

Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea & coffee afterwards. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 pm and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up.



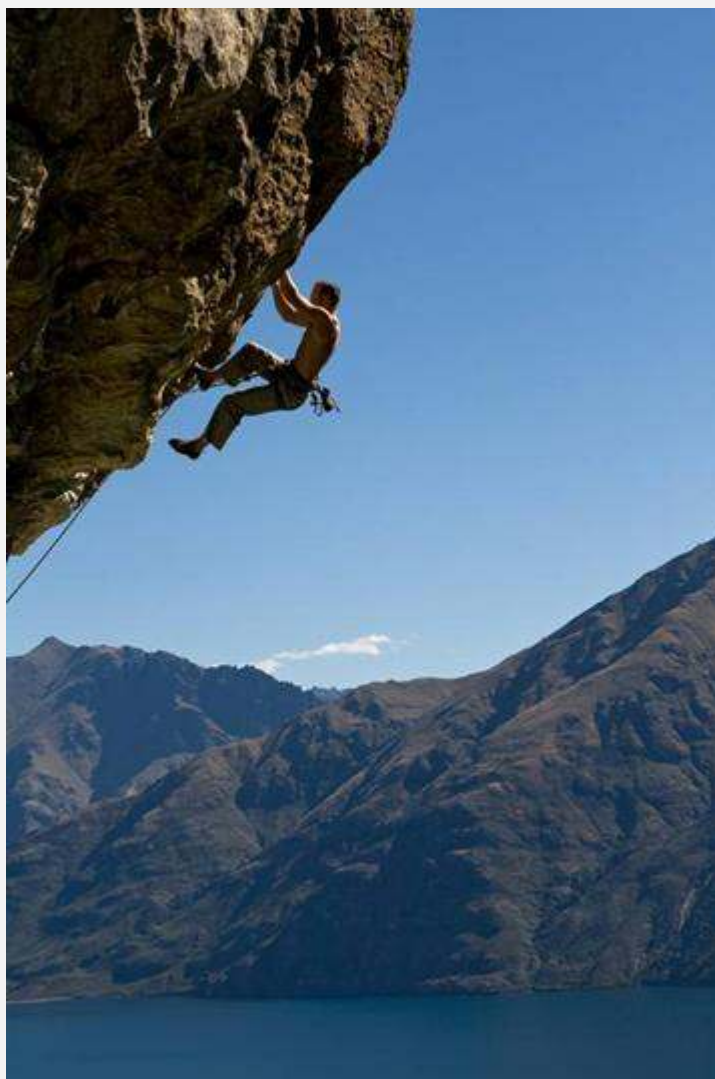
Next section night: 14 June 2010

Photo Competition – Judged by John Rhodes, Shaun Barnett, Andy Reisinger and Matt Evans

At the June clubnight we will be presenting the results of the 2010 Wellington Section photo competition.

This year we have a full panel of judges; John Rhodes, Shaun Barnett, Andy Reisinger and Matt Evans and they will be presenting a selection of the best shots for the audience to choose the final winners.

See your best photos on the big screen, get feedback from photography experts, vote on this year's best shots and be in to win great prizes from our sponsors.



Last year's Honours Rock Climbing - Eat yourself fitter, Wye Creek, by John Palmer



TRIP REPORTS

Please send your trip reports to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, so everyone can enjoy your stories.

Kawakawa Bay

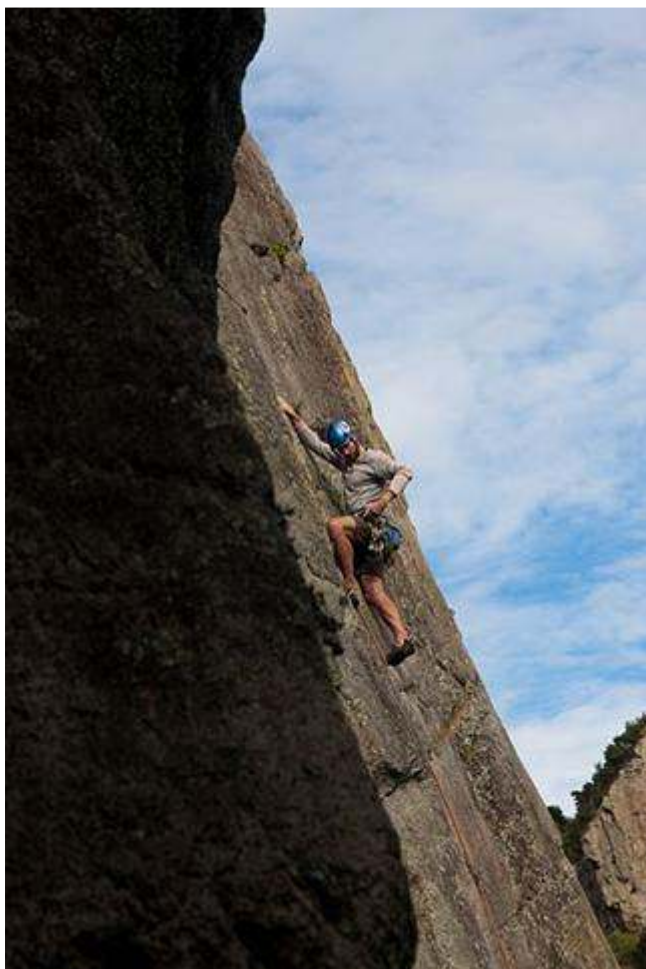
On the northern shores of Lake Taupo, Kawakawa Bay is less well known than some of the other rock climbing areas in the central North Island because it's a bit of a hike to get out there – by cragging standards, at least. An exhausting one and a half hour walk would probably get you to the crag. So we got a water taxi.

Some would claim that this shows just how lazy we are. Others would suggest that the lack of a true trip report in Vertigo supports this claim. I would counter that a photo is worth a thousand words, so this is actually quite a long essay...

Steve Minchin, ShiChang Hou, Kevin Robertshaw, Reece Geursen, Kevin Patterson, Jin Ong, Bradley Markle, Vincent Zintzen, and Rebecca Thomson were on the trip. Good times were had by all :D



Vincent on Great Scott
Photo courtesy of Vincent Zintzen



Reece on Gecko Groove
Photo courtesy of Vincent Zintzen



Kevin on Great Scott
Photo courtesy of Jin Ong



Kevin contemplates the pros and cons of a deepwater solo
Photo courtesy of Jin Ong



Steve on Rohan's Arete



Jin on Jug Addiction as night falls



Sitting around the campfire, hatching plans to go for a quick climb in the dark...
Photos courtesy of Jin Ong

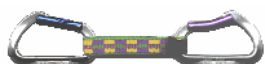


UPCOMING CLUB TRIPS



Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the Wellington Section. Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email us or approach us at the monthly meeting, and we can help you get going. Send your trip ideas, no matter how vague, to trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



Mt Tapuae-o-Uenuku

Date: 4-7 June 2010 (Queen's Birthday weekend)

Leader: Waimaria Erueti

Level: AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

Opening alpine snow trip for the winter season! Come climb the second highest peak in NZ outside the Mt Cook area. This was one of Hillary's early climbs back in the 1940's, except instead of doing it in 1 day like Sir Ed did we'll take 3! On Friday night we'll take the ferry and stay near the road end. Saturday will be the trip in up the Hodder River to stay at the Hodder Huts – some 66 crossings! On Sunday we'll attempt a summit via the traditional north ridge. No ropes required. Contact Waimaria at 380 6277(h) or 027 289 3024 or by email at waimariaeruetti@gmail.com



Mt Tapuae-o-Uenuku summit ridge



Ruapehu South

Date: 9-11 July 2010

Leader: TBA

Level: AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

On Friday night we will drive up to Ohakune and either tent near the mountain road or stay at the backpackers. Saturday we will ascend the highest point on Ruapehu = Taurangi peak (2797m) returning for a pub meal at the Powderhorn in the evening. On Sunday we will attempt Girdlestone (2658m), the outlying peak on the right of Taurangi by crossing the Mangaehuehu Glacier. Contact Kevin at 934 0975 (evenings) or email me at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz.



Ruapehu North - Te Heu Heu, Dome, and Paretaitonga

Date: 13-15 August 2010

Leader: Peter Ellis

Level: AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

The plan is to drive up to Whakapapa, and climb up to Delta Corner Hut on Friday night. On Saturday we will stroll up to the crater, inspect the Dome shelter (2672m) and attempt Paratetaitonga (2751m), returning to Delta Corner for the evening. On Sunday we will return to the crater and attempt Te Heu Heu (2732m) along the main ridge, descending the skifield to the car park and home thereafter. Contact Peter at 021 934 482 (evenings) or email me at ellisp@netspeed.com.au



Mt Taranaki / Egmont

Date: 10-12 September 2010

Leader: TBA

Level: AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

On Friday night we will drive up to Taranaki and walk in for 2h to Taurangi Lodge. Saturday we will ascend to the crater and then summit of Taranaki. Those who are especially adventurous might like to have a go at Sharks Tooth. Sunday may involve a jaunt to Humpries Castle or the Organ Pipes for a bit of rock climbing. Contact Kevin at 934 0975 (evenings) or email me at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz.



CLASSIFIEDS



Marmot CWM EQ (Regular) Sleeping Bag

As new condition, purchased for a Himalayan trip from which I had to withdraw and has only been slept in twice. Rated for -40 degrees C. \$950 ono. Contact Ben 021 975 790.



Perfect Climbers Van

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\$21,000 ono

email: iain.lea1@googlemail.com





Mountaineering boots, rope

Koflach Womens Viva Soft snow and ice mountaineering boots. Made and bought in Austria a number of years ago. Size US 7.5, EU 7 (approx. 38). Never been used, still in box with label attached. Bought for over \$400

Edelweiss Climbing rope, 9 or maybe 9.5, 50m. Used once on a single pitch rock climb. Bought a number of years ago. Stored in dry dark cupboard. Pink!!

Offers on both of these.

Andrea Gerbic, minniegg12@gmail.com



NZ Alpine Journal 1935-1978

FOR SALE: NZAJ 1935-1978 (not a complete run)

Most in good condition or better, \$10.00 each plus postage

Contact: Graham Langton

Email: langtons@ihug.co.nz

Phone: 04 383 8868



NOTICES



Grampians, Bouldering

The Grampians National Park is undoubtedly Australia's best bouldering destination. Its bullet-hard sandstone, pocketed roof climbing and idyllic situations attract climbers from all over the world. This colourful guide describes over 600 problems across 20 of the best bouldering locations within the park. Full colour, 208 pages.

Published: 3rd edition 2009

Authors: David Pearson and Chris Webb Parsons

Price: \$65.00 (Member: \$50.00)

<http://alpineclub.org.nz/product/grampians-selected-climbs>



Wanaka Rock 2005 Edition

A guide to rock climbing and bouldering around Lake Wanaka. Last of five copies of the 2005 edition on sale - only while stocks last!

Published: 2005

Authors: Wanaka Rock Club Inc.

Price: \$30.00 (Member: \$25.00)

<http://alpineclub.org.nz/product/wanaka-rock>



NBS 2010 Women's T-shirt

National Bouldering Series 2010, organic cotton T-shirts (red only). Made in New Zealand by iconic manufacturer Chalky Digits. Only two women's sizes left, so we are putting the last of this limited stock on sale. Remaining sizes are three only size 10 and seven only of size 8.

Price: \$25.00 (Member: \$25.00)

<http://alpineclub.org.nz/product/nbs-2010-womens-t-shirt>



10mm hangers

10mm hangers will soon be available again, just waiting on ordered stock to arrive, (price tba, but not expected to be too much dearer than at present). Our new supplier has assured us that we should have no problems reordering and therefore we hope to maintain our stock levels better than has been the case in the past. We are no longer stocking 12mm hangers, but these can be purchased from Aspiring Enterprises in Christchurch instead. We will continue to stock 10mm ring hangers and 10mm x 120mm eye bolts however. If you would like to backorder hangers, then please contact Margaret@alpineclub.org.nz to arrange this.



Hangdog Camp

The climbers campground of Hangdog, near Takaka, New Zealand, has today been closed until further notice - ostensibly for maintenance, but the actual reason being non-compliance with standard council campground regulations. These regulations are aimed at the likes of Top 10 holiday parks, and include requirements such as having to provide a washing machine and individually marked campsites. In the past, Hangdog has had an exemption from these regulation, for its specific climbing-based purpose and clientele. This exemption has however expired, and the local council will not renew it as it sees no further need for this type of campground.

If you have stayed at this campground, were happy with what you found and the way it operated, and if you want it to continue, please send your thoughts to the Tasman District Council.

Attached is my attempted petition letter (see <http://paynesford.blogspot.com/>) for the continuation of the Hangdog. Feel free to add your own comments or to write your own letter entirely - as it will be good for the Tasman District Council to hear all of your views! :)

I have included both TDC's Takaka and Richmond (Head Office) addresses, in order to cover both ends. Feel free to pass on this template, and any additional thoughts, to your climbing friends around the globe.

Warm regards to everyone,

Henry

Henriette Beikirch

E: henriette_beikirch@yahoo.co.nz

M: (+)64 (0)21 1146 122



Hangdog winter bouldering series

Every year HangDog hosts the Winter Bouldering Series. Don't worry if you aren't competitive, the series is also social and relaxed, with grades starting from VE (like climbing a really fun ladder). There's something for everyone, with recreational, elite and under 16 categories.

How does it work?

Easily... Here is the scenario. Everybody who enters gets a copy of a list of climbs and some paper to record their scores. Climbers wander around watching the other climbers, relaxing, chatting, and (when they feel like it) doing the climbs they choose to do. At the end of the night everyone hands in their paper and the scores are compared... and that's it. Very casual and easy.

Who can enter?

Everyone...The most important thing to know is that you don't have to be good. While the serious climbers take the competition seriously, most people are there to watch and have a good time.

When is it?

6:30pm till 9:30pm on 16th and 23rd of June. The final is on the night of Saturday the 26th of June and coincides with the NZAC National Boulder Series.

How much does it cost?

Only \$10 or \$5 for members





Fergs prices

I wish to inform on behalf of Ian Ferguson as climbing club members of various clubs that you can please pass this email on to other members so that the word gets out that there is going to be an increase to club prices and general climbing prices at Fergs Kayaks that will be in effect from the 30th of April 2010.

The major changes will be for club members will be the normal charge of \$8 any day of the week will be going up to \$10 and on the club nights the \$5 charge will go up to \$8 dollars.

Mike Osborn
Fergs Kayaks



Alpine Light – Photography Exhibition by Richard Young

In our busy lives, we don't often notice light unless there is none. In the mountains light and the effect it has on the landscape, becomes more apparent.

Alpine Light is an exhibition of mountain photography, of views of great peaks and mountain horizons, where the effect of light can be seen as it's reflected off the snow and on to it's surrounding landscape.

Exhibition opening Sunday 13th June 2pm-5pm and runs 13th-27th June at Bay Gallery, 4 School Road, Plimmerton.

Opening times Friday 4pm-8pm, Saturday 1pm-4.30pm, Sunday (20th & 27th) 10am-2pm

Also showing at the New Zealand Mountain Film Festival, Wanaka, 2nd-6th July, see www.mountainfilm.net.nz for details.





NZAC Winter Instruction Programme

Brought to you in conjunction with Black Diamond

This winter the NZAC, in conjunction with Black Diamond, are offering instruction courses for those members' wanting to improve their ice climbing skills, or become back country skiers.

Progression to Leading on Ice

Have you ever been stopped on a route because you couldn't climb that pesky pitch of ice between you and the summit? Or wanted to tackle that frozen water fall but not had the confidence? Or been worried about how to get down again? This is the course for you!

Based at Porter Lodge, you will be taught the correct skills for leading on ice by qualified guides. It's best you've had some experience, whether it's taking part in the 'Whack n' Dangle' weekend at Fox or a day top roping at Ruapehu, although strong rock climbers will do well on this course.

When: July 16th- 19th (three days)

Where: Fox Glacier

Cost: \$650 (Includes accommodation, instruction, ropes,)

Introduction to Back Country Skiing

Always wanted to go backcountry skiing but been unsure of what's involved? This course is a chance to learn the ins and outs of back country skiing in some of the best mountain ski terrain in the country.

Based at the remote Mt Olympus Ski Field Lodge, participants will learn how to be safe and efficient on skis in the mountains. Topics include: equipment, trip planning, terrain analyses, avalanche analyses, avalanche victim search, snow shelters etc.

Nb: This is not a 'learn to ski' course, nor is it an Avalanche Awareness Course. Participants are expected to be strong intermediate (or better) skiers with excellent fitness! Although there will be an avalanche awareness component to the course, participants would expect to do a separate course on the subject if they were to continue with back country skiing.

When: September 5th- September 10th (five days)

Where: Mt Olympus Ski Field

Cost : \$1250 (Includes: food, accommodation, instruction and a nominal daily lift pass for access)

Courses hold eight people each with a 1:4 guide student ratio.

If you are interested in either of these, contact Pat Deavoll for further information and an application form - pat@alpineclub.org.nz, ph. 03 337 7595 - or go to the NZAC website instruction page: <http://alpineclub.org.nz/default/24>



Jon Muir Speaker Tour

Jon Muir, Australian mountaineer, Everest summitter and polar and desert explorer, is regarded as one of the great adventurers of the last century. He was making epic ascents in the Himalaya's at a very young age, has trekked to both the North and South Poles, and several years ago made an unsupported trek the length of Australia; a fete he says made all his other accomplishments pale in significance.

John is a true 'character' and his speaker tours in Australia have been feted as 'genius'. He will be touring New Zealand in late August/ early September. Don't miss your opportunity to hear his fascinating story.

Jon will be in Wellington on August 31. Tickets will be available in the coming weeks.



NZAC Photographic Competition

Dust off your cameras! The New Zealand Alpine Club Photographic Competition opens in June 15th. This is your chance to see your winning photograph feature in the Climber, the Journal or the Calendar!

Last year we had the largest number of entries ever, and for the first time, a Youth Category. This year the Youth Category has been pushed out to 20 years and under.

Digital images can be submitted online and we accept slides; see the entry form included in the next issue of Climber, or keep an eye out on the website- it will be updated within the next few weeks.



Centenary of first female ascent of Aoraki / Mt Cook

December 3rd, 2010 marks the hundred year anniversary of Freda Du Faur's historic first female ascent of Aoraki / Mt Cook.

Freda was the leading amateur climber of her era (both male and female) and capped her climbing career off with the first grand traverse of the Aoraki / Mt Cook two years after her first ascent.

She was one of the great talents in New Zealand's climbing history and her first ascent is worthy of a celebration.

The NZAC would like to hear expressions of interest from individuals who have ideas for, or would like to play a part in, the organisation of this celebration. This could range from making a celebratory female ascent of Aoraki / Mt Cook to being part of the organisation of an event at Mt Cook village.

If you have ideas and would like to be involved, contact Pat Deavoll at pat@alpineclub.org.nz



Waipapa Dam closures

NZAC have been in discussions with Mighty River Power (MRP) who are the landowners of the Waipapa Dam area. This has resulted in permanent closure of one area, and temporary closure of other areas. We urge members to note the restrictions on climbing outlined below, and adhere to them! If climbers want to continue to enjoy access to this fantastic climbing area then they must respect these requests.

This ban includes all abseiling, and recreational, educational and commercial climbing instruction courses. PLEASE DO NOT CLIMB IN CLOSED AREAS!

Car Park Wall Closure

The Car Park wall at Waipapa is closed to all climbers and the hardware is to be removed. This is at the request of the land owners, Mighty River Power, and the NZAC fully support this decision and ask that all climbers respect this closure and do not to climb in this area. Climbing in this area will only jeopardise future access to the other crags in the Waipapa area.

Lakeside and Crack Wall closures

Climbing at the Lakeside and Crack walls are closed. The NZAC are currently in negotiations with the land owners (MRP) and are working on solutions to reopen these areas. In the mean time please do not climb at either of these locations - MRP will install "No Climbing" signs at Lakeside track and wall. Climbing in these areas will only lead to a total ban and the removal of hardware from these crags.

River Wall, Main Cliff, and Galaxy Wall

Climbing in these areas is still open. However please respect any track closure signs or requests during the construction of the national cycleway path. Climbers have a duty of care to respect any temporary request by land owners to limit access to an area. This can be done for any number of reasons such as construction in or around the area, lambing or calving, logging.

If climbers want to continue to enjoy access to private land then they must respect these requests. Please note that all references to any climbing at the above crags have been removed from www.freeclimb.co.nz



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Did I mention better routes?
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\$255



\$295



\$360



\$360



\$230

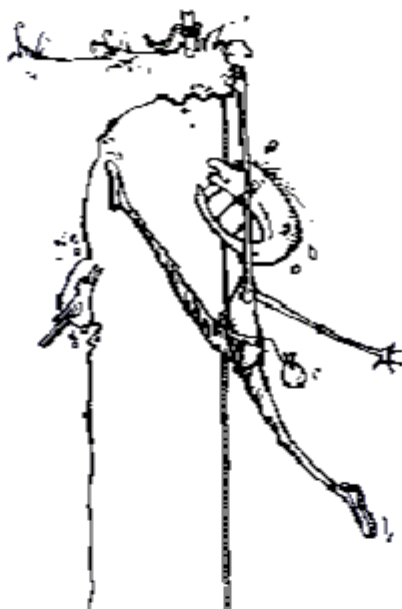


\$370



WELLINGTON SECTION: 2010/11 CONTACT LIST

Position	Name	Email alias*	Phone
Chairperson	Vacant	chairperson	
Vice Chair	Vacant	vicechair	
Secretary	Catherine Moger	secretary or CM2	04 973 1307 (h) 021 079 0854
Acting Treasurer	Richard Davies	Treasurer	
National Rep	James Wright	JW	027 472 5561
Instruction Convenor	Don French	DF	
Trips	Kevin Patterson	Trips or KP	04 934 0975 (h) 027 687 9573
Other Committee Members	Richard Davies	RD	
	Scott Taylor	ST	
	ShiChang Hou	SH	
	Steve Minchin	SM	
	Gwen Rashbrooke		
	Hinrich Schaefer		
	Rebecca Thomson		
Other Roles:			
Gear	Marcus Manning	gear	
Personal Locator Beacons	Kevin Patterson	PLB or KP	
Instruction - AIC	Don French	AIC or DF	06 3777 117 (h) 027 445 2980
Instruction - Rock	Blair Hiscoke	summerrock or BH	
Library	Derek Richardson	library	
	Peter Shanahan	PS2	
Newsletter Editor	Steve Minchin	newsletter or SM	
Rock Drill overseer	Kristen Foley	drill or KF	
Website	Richard Thomson	webmaster	
* Email address is: alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz eg. secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz			
Any membership, Distaghil Sar Fund, or general queries should be directed to the secretary			
Any media queries should be directed to:			
National Executive Officer	Ollie Clifton	ollie@alpineclub.org.nz	03 3777 595



If undelivered please return to:

NZAC Wellington Section
PO Box 1628
Wellington

